First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Tuesday - Friday 9am-2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Friday 9:30am - Noon
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Nancy Holland
Acolytes: Mykala Pryor and Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

November 24, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Bailey Brown, Choir & Music Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Reign of Christ Sunday November 24, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:**
When I despair, I remember that all through history the way of truth and love have always won. There have been tyrants and murderers, and for a time, they can seem invincible, but in the end, they always fall. Think of it–always." — Mahatma Gandhi

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *Awake, Awake to Love and Work* arr. Conrady

Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship Come and Fill Our Hearts (Taizé)

Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
You alone, O God, are holy.
Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
Al-le-lu--ia!

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

Sovereign God, the wind blows, the water flows, and the sun shines. All creation declares your majesty. In you, we move, live, and have our being. Be glorified in our worship. Be known by our testimony. We proclaim your goodness from the east and the west, from the north and the south. On countryside and city blocks, you reign. In deep valleys and skyscrapers, we declare that your realm extends from everlasting to everlasting. We worship you, Holy One, in spirit and in truth. Amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
First Congregational Church of St Albans
Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
St. Luke's Episcopal Church, St. Albans
Sheldon Interfaith Food Shelf
Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
Congregational Church of So. Hero
Our local Girl Scout Troop
As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
F/GI Community Action
Voices Against Violence
Samaritan House
Restorative Justice Center
Pathways
Reach-Up
Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

HYMN*

We Gather Together NCH 421

PRAYER OF TRANSFORMATION[1] **(Unison)**
Magnificent God, your greatness humbles us. Your love can be overwhelming and incomprehensible. Your attentive care takes our breath. We recognize that we sometimes suppress the holiness you have embedded in us. We keep silent when our witness could make a difference. We turn away when the pain we observe in others becomes more than we can bear. Renew our spirits, strengthen our resolve, and fortify our compassion to put testimony on our lips, in our posts, and through our lives for your kin-dom. Amen.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION
WORDS OF ASSURANCE
PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN

ANTHEM *Thanksgiving Eve* by Bob Franke
arr. Peter Amidon

SCRIPTURE READING John 18:33-37

MORNING REFLECTION
"**Thankful**"

HYMN*

Rock of Ages, Cleft for Me (1,2,4) NCH 596

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

"*Hear Our Prayer, O Lord*" D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

Choral Response To Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee.*"

Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

Holy, Holy, Holy (1,2,3) NCH 277

Benediction

Postlude *Eternal God, Whose Power Upholds*
arr. Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- ❖ Maria Barresi, Sandy Cristman, and Jessica Pecor Thank You for answering the call and creating Self-Care Gift Bags for our caseworker colleagues at CVOEO and Pathways!

Sunday Nov. 24
11:30am
Join in the fun as we decorate the Sanctuary for Advent and Christmas.

Christmas Cookie Bake, Swap, Share!
Saturday December 14th, 1-6pm
Please sign up on sheet at coffee hour
For more info TEXT Val: 802)370-6417

Ecumenical Caroling Fun
@ local care facilities.
Dec 14th exact time TBA; rehearsal on Dec. 12th 6pm at St. Albans Bay UMC.

Christmas Mission : The Mitten Tree
We are currently collecting mittens and scarves to be distributed to local organizations and schools, who will in turn distribute them to individuals for the upcoming cold weather. Knitting instructions are available--just ask! Purchased items are also being accepted.

Zoom Bible Study:
No Bible Study until Dec. 11

Online Giving:
Wi-Fi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123

